Reading · Part 5 — Urban Transportation

Multilevel · Questions 30–35

Many cities have come under considerable strain in recent years, largely as a consequence of the increase of population. Rapid urbanization has resulted in a higher concentration of people within metropolitan areas, placing excessive pressure on transport infrastructure. As a result, issues such as congestion, extended commuting times, and environmental degradation have become increasingly difficult to manage.

To alleviate these problems, many authorities support the introduction of autonomous vehicles, since they are capable of enhancing the efficiency of transport systems. Unlike conventional modes of transport that rely heavily on human drivers, these vehicles operate through advanced algorithms and real-time data processing. This allows them to maintain consistent movement, minimize delays, and in some cases reduce operational costs. Although critics argue that such systems may initially be expensive to implement, proponents emphasize their long-term benefits in improving accessibility and reliability.

When it comes to long-distance travel, conventional diesel-fuel buses are gradually being phased out due to their environmental impact. Instead, they can be substituted with hydrogen buses, which are widely regarded as a cleaner alternative. While electric buses remain a viable option, they often depend on large battery systems that require frequent charging, making them less practical for extended routes.

In contrast, hydrogen-powered vehicles offer greater flexibility, particularly in terms of refuelling time and range. Furthermore, electrolysis is often used as an alternative method of producing hydrogen, especially when compared with battery-powered systems. This process involves using electricity — ideally generated from renewable sources — to split water into hydrogen and oxygen. Consequently, when renewable energy is utilised, the entire cycle can be considered environmentally sustainable.

Despite these advancements, it is important to recognise that no single solution can fully resolve urban transport challenges. Nevertheless, many experts agree that integrating innovative technologies with cleaner energy sources represents a crucial step towards more sustainable cities.

Questions 30–33

Fill in the missing information. Write NO MORE THAN ONE WORD AND / OR A NUMBER.

30. Many cities have high pressure due to the increase of [[population]].

31. Many authorities support [[autonomous]] vehicles, since they make transportation frequent and cheap.

32. For long journeys, diesel-fuel buses can be replaced by [[hydrogen]] buses.

33. [[electrolysis]] is often used as an alternative instead of battery-powered ones.

Questions 34–35

Choose the correct answer A, B, C or D.

34. What is true about green hydrogen?

A) It is produced from fossil fuels.
B) It is powered by renewable energy.
C) It is less efficient than diesel.
D) It cannot be used in transport.

35. Which answer reflects the writer’s opinion?

A) Autonomous vehicles are too expensive.

B) Diesel transport is still preferable.

C) Cleaner transport solutions are necessary.

D) Public transport should be reduced.

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Answer key

30-population 31-autonomous 32-hydrogen 33-electrolysis 34-B 35-C

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